A friend of mine in Edmonton had presented me with a golf set, but I had no wish whatsoever to take up the game and carelessly asked him what I should do with it. He insisted that I should keep it and so, the set came back to India with me. For a long time it languished in a forgotten corner of the house, gathering dust. One day, when I was taking my usual run along the golf course, I was stopped by Dharma Vira, then the governor of Punjab, who asked, 'Milkha, why are you running around the course? Come, I'll teach you how to play golf instead. '

'No', I replied emphatically, 'it's an old man's game, and I find it too slow and boring.' He laughed at my dismissal of the game he loved, and retorted, 'Bring your set tomorrow and I will give you lessons.'

The next day, I dusted the grime off my set, went to the golf course and had my first lesson. I have to admit that the game intrigued me, and after that first lesson I was addicted and would rush to the course whenever I had any free time.

When Jeev was little, he would follow me around the course, fascinated by my every move. Day by day his interest grew until it became an obsession. I had no objection to my children dabbling in sports; what I didn't want was for them to take it up as a professional career. They had been brought up in the lap of luxury and I didn't think that they had the disciple and will power to work hard. In sheer desperation, I got him admitted in one of India's most prestigious public schools, Bishop Cotton in Simla. Both Nimmi and Jeev were very upset but I insisted. He spent two years at Bishop Cotton, from 1983 to 1985.

Though we had sent Jeev to boarding school, his passion for golf did not diminish. It was then that I understood that it was destiny that had led my son to golf.

In January 1985, when he had come down for the winter vacations, Jeev participated and won the American Express Golf Tournament at the Delhi Golf Club. He was thirteen years old then. After winning the tournament he returned to Bishop Cotton to sit for the Class 7 final examinations. Meanwhile, we had got him admission in a school in Chandigarh, Shivalik Public School, so that he could study as well as play golf. In June, he left for Woodbridge in England for a month-long coaching camp. This was the starting point on his road to fame.

In 1987, when he was fifteen and in Class 9, he participated in the Doug Sanders golf scholarship selections. He won at each stage of the